

Assignment 3
30 Marks
Deadline: Jul 24, 2025 (Thursday)

1. An interpolating polynomial, $p_1(x) = 1.648(x - 1)$ is derived for the function $f(x) = x \ln x$ at the nodes ($x_0 = 1$, $x_1 = 5$) using the Lagrange method. Answer the following keeping up to 4 significant figures.

- (a) (1 mark) Explain what you need to do to obtain a **degree 3** interpolating polynomial for the same function $f(x)$ and for the same nodal points ($x_0 = 1$, $x_1 = 5$).
- (b) (4 marks) Calculate the bases of the **degree 3** polynomial. (Keep up to 4 significant figures for larger values)

2. Consider the following **Runge Function** $f(x) = 1/(1+25x^2)$, given interval $[-4, 6]$ and $n = 2$. Answer the following using the given data,

- (a) [5 marks] Calculate the corresponding **equal angles**.
- (b) [5 marks] Calculate the **Chebyshev Nodes** up to 5 significant figures.

3. (3 + 2 Marks) The following Dataset is generated by the function $f(x) = x \cos(x) - x + \sin(x)$.

x	1.1	1.2	1.3
f(x)	0.2902	0.1669	0.01131

Based on the above data, compute $f'(1.2)$ using the **Central Difference and Backward Difference** method, and also calculate the **relative error**. Use 4 significant figures. Also compute the upper bound of the truncation error of $f(x)$ for **Backward Difference**.

4. Consider the function $f(x) = x \ln(x)$. Now answer the following:

- (a) **[Ungraded]** Evaluate the numerical derivative of $f(x)$ at $x = 1.0$ with step size $h = 0.1$ using the **forward and central difference** methods up to 5 significant figures.
- (b) **[Ungraded]** Compute the upper bound of the truncation error of $f(x)$ at $x = 1.0$ using $h = 0.1$ for the **backward and central difference** methods up to 5 significant figures.
- (c) [10 Marks] Deduce an expression for $D_h^{(1)}$ by replacing h with $(4h/3)$ using the Richardson Extrapolation method.

